

knowledge in Linux and Open Source Software is now available in North America. Linux Essentials was initially released as a pilot programme in Europe, the Middle East and Africa, but due to popular demand has now been launched in North America.

Targeted at new technology users, the Linux Essentials programme has been adopted by schools, educational authorities, training centres and others across the regions mentioned.

The Linux Essentials programme has been under development by LPI for approximately two years and includes the participation of qualification authorities, academic partners, private trainers, publishers, government organisations, volunteer IT professionals, and Linux and Open Source experts. The single Linux Essentials' exam leads to a 'Certificate of Achievement' recognising knowledge of the following subject matters:

- The Linux Community and a Career in Open Source
- Popular Operating Systems and Major Open Source Applications
- Understanding Open Source Software and Licensing
- Linux Command Line Basics, Files and Scripts

An online exam will also be conducted either through LPI or partner Internet-based testing (IBT) institutions.



Linux 3.7 gets 64-bit ARM support

While the release of Linux 3.6 is making waves in the open source circuit, Linus Torvalds has merged support for 64-bit ARM architecture for version 3.7 into the main Linux kernel development tree. Officially known as AArch64, several requests by kernel developers led to the code for the architecture being placed in a separate arch/arm64/ directory in the kernel source code.

Previously, it had been reported that a set of 36 patches was released by an employee at ARM, named Catalin Marinas, which would extend the Linux kernel to provide support for ARM's AArch64 64-bit architecture. Accordingly, this 64-bit ARM support was to be provided by the ARMv8 instruction set, as announced in the autumn of 2011. It was expected to be first used in processors in 2014.

By late 2012, Applied Micro Circuits Corporation (AMCC) is expected to be coming up with its first sample chips on 64-bit ARM cores. Along with this, a patch collection will be integrated in the main Linux development tree, which boots on a range of different 32-bit ARM platforms that are to be built.

HP introduces Open webOS 1.0

When webOS from HP did not go down well in the market, the company decided to go the open source way. HP has officially released the version 1.0 of its Open webOS, which is exclusively optimised for touchscreens. The company had introduced the beta version in August. The source code is licensed under the Apache Licence 2.0. Open webOS 1.0 carries the key components of WebOS along with the Enyo 2 JavaScript application framework that was developed as part of the webOS project. It also includes building scripts for Linux and OpenEmbedded.

Nokia's open source OS, MeeGo, gets new lease of life

Recently, it was announced by Jolla, the Finnish mobile phone start-up, that it will be providing funds worth \$260 million to resurrect the open source MeeGo mobile operating system. The company has also announced via its official Facebook page that it will showcase the new user interface of the OS along with details about the app ecosystem and SDK, at the Slush start-up conference to be held in Helsinki, Finland on November 21- 22 this year.



The MeeGo mobile OS was abandoned by Nokia, leading Jolla to adopt it in July. Jolla is looking forward to design and develop new smartphones based on it. MeeGo's popularity was increased by Nokia's N9, which is so far the only MeeGo smartphone to be released.

According to recent reports, Jolla has announced that it has raised \$260 million in funding, and that its first smartphone is almost ready for release. According to Digital Trends, "Jolla plans to aggressively target the Asian and Chinese markets, calling China a game changer in the technology industry, adding how it wants to create the third smartphone ecosystem in China, after Android and iOS."

Jolla's MeeGo OS has been codenamed Sailfish, and is expected to make its first appearance very soon. Company sources claim it is more open than Google's Android with respect to apps and service development, and have revealed in a tweet that with the ecosystem support system in place, the company is very close to announcing the date for the device's launch.